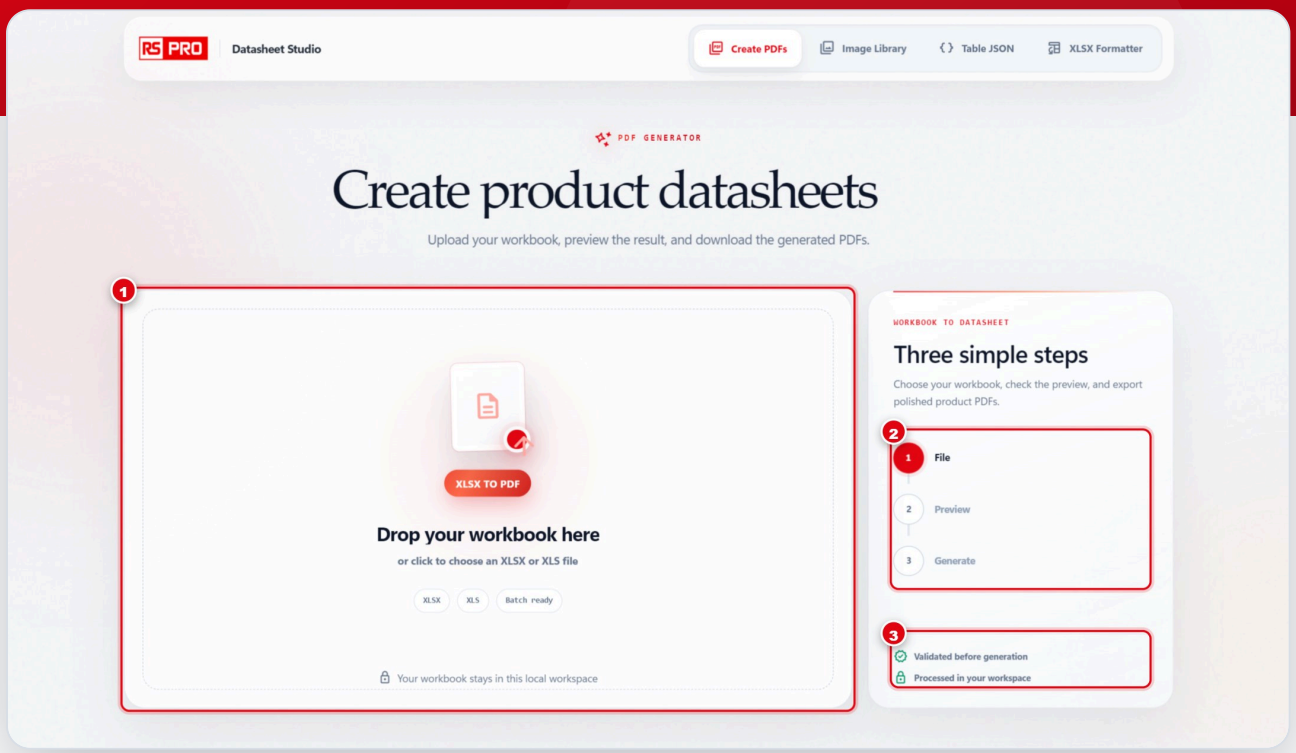
USER MANUAL

Datasheet Studio

Turn product spreadsheets into polished RS PRO datasheets. Manage images, extract tables and prepare workbooks — step by step, in plain English.



Create PDFs · Image Library · Table JSON · XLSX Formatter

WHO THIS IS FOR

Content and catalogue team members who prepare product datasheets. No technical knowledge is needed.

VERSION

1.0
October 2026

OPEN IT

Use the Datasheet Studio link shared by your team

WELCOME

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BEFORE YOU START

How to use this manual

This manual explains every screen of **Datasheet Studio**, what each button does, and how the pieces work together. You do not need any technical background.

If you are in a hurry

FIRST TIME

Read chapters 1 and 2

Understand what the website does and how to open it. About 10 minutes.

DAILY WORK

Jump to the tool you need

Chapters 3 to 6 each cover one tool, with numbered steps and screenshots.

SOMETHING WENT WRONG

Go to chapter 8

A symptom-to-fix table covers the problems people meet most often.

QUICK REMINDER

Use chapter 9

A one-page checklist and a glossary of every special word.

How the screenshots are marked

Most screenshots carry **red numbered circles**. The same numbers are explained in the list directly under the picture, so you can match what you see on your screen with the description.

Tip

Coloured boxes appear throughout the manual. **Tip** = a faster or safer way to work. **Note** = background information. **Important** = avoid a common mistake. **Stop** = something that can lose work or produce a wrong result.

Note

The screenshots use real sample products from the RS PRO Batch 8 workbook. Your own file names, product names and numbers will be different, but every screen works the same way.

CHAPTER 1

1 About Datasheet Studio

1.1 What the website does

Datasheet Studio turns a **spreadsheet of product information** into a **finished, branded RS PRO datasheet PDF** for every product — in one click, for dozens of products at a time.

A product datasheet normally needs a title, a main photo, a list of features, a description and several specification tables. Instead of laying these out by hand in a design tool, you fill in one spreadsheet row per product. The website reads the row, builds the page layout, and produces the PDF.

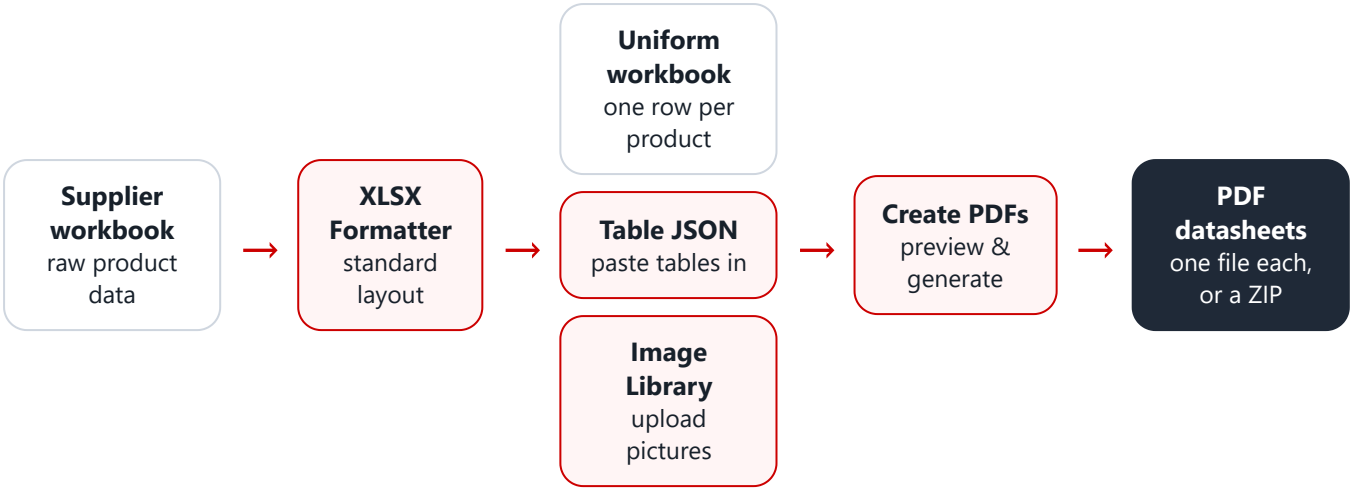
Around that main job, the website gives you three helper tools: a place to keep product images, a tool that converts tables from PDFs or pictures into spreadsheet-ready text, and a tool that reshapes a supplier's workbook into the exact layout the PDF generator expects.

1.2 The four tools at a glance

Tool (top menu)	What it does	You give it → you get
Create PDFs	Builds one datasheet PDF per product row, with preview, duplicate check and batch download.	A finished workbook → PDF files or one ZIP
Image Library	Stores product pictures and diagrams so the PDFs can find them by file name.	Image files → a searchable library
Table JSON	Reads a table from a PDF or picture and writes it as text that can be pasted into a workbook cell.	A PDF or image → table JSON (or a one-row-per-PDF workbook)
XLSX Formatter	Converts a supplier workbook into the standard "uniform" layout, grouping attributes into table columns.	A supplier XLSX → a PDF-ready XLSX

1.3 How the pieces fit together

The tools are used in a natural order. The figure below shows the usual journey from supplier data to finished PDFs.



Red-outlined boxes are tools inside Datasheet Studio. You can use any tool on its own; the order above is simply the most common route.

1.4 Four words you will see often

Word	Meaning
Workbook	An Excel file (XLSX or XLS). In this manual, the *uniform workbook* is the one the PDF generator reads.
SKU / stock number	The product code, for example `SA1210/P2IG-NP`. It becomes the PDF file name.
Table JSON	A table written as text, such as `{"section":"Approvals","headers":[],"rows":[...]}`. The PDF generator turns it into a formatted table.
Batch	Many products processed together from one workbook.

CHAPTER 2

2 Getting started

2.1 Open the website

Open **Google Chrome** or **Microsoft Edge** and go to the Datasheet Studio link that your team shared with you. You do not need to install anything.

> **Tip**
> Add the page to your browser bookmarks so you can open it in one click. If a page ever looks stuck, press `F5` to refresh it.

2.2 A quick tour of the screen

Every page has the same frame. Along the top is the menu with the four tools; the large heading below it tells you which tool is open.

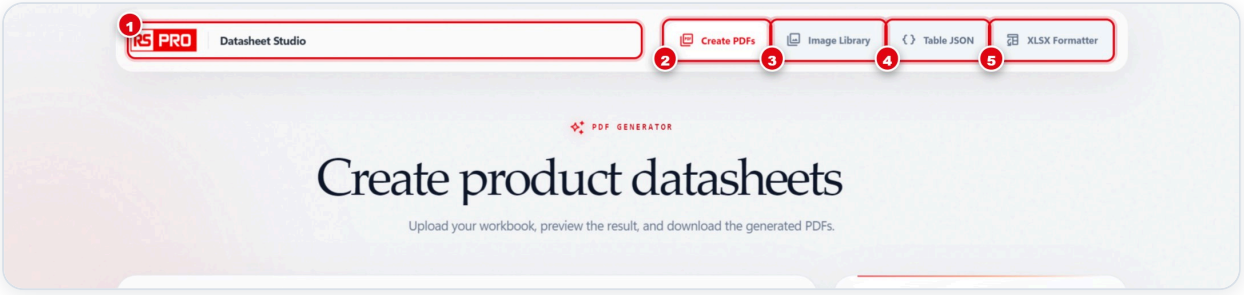


Figure 1. The top of every screen. The highlighted tab is the tool you are currently using.

1. **Brand area** — the RS PRO logo and the product name, *Datasheet Studio*.
2. **Create PDFs** — turn a finished workbook into datasheet PDFs.
3. **Image Library** — upload and manage product images.
4. **Table JSON** — turn tables from PDFs or pictures into spreadsheet-ready text.
5. **XLSX Formatter** — reshape a supplier workbook into the standard layout.

Below the heading, the right-hand panel on each tool shows a short **three-step guide** (for example *File → Preview → Generate*) that moves forward as you complete each step.

2.3 Where your results go

What	Where it ends up
Generated PDFs	Downloaded by your browser — one PDF, or a ZIP when there are several. Look in your Downloads folder.
Uploaded pictures	Kept in the **Image Library** until someone deletes them.
Your workbook	Never changed by the website. It only reads it.

CHAPTER 3

3 Create PDFs

This is the main tool. You give it a finished workbook and it produces one datasheet PDF for every product row.

3.1 Before you begin

Make sure these are ready. Each point is explained in later chapters.

- ✓ Your workbook is in the **uniform layout** (two header rows, one product per row). If you only have a supplier file, use the **XLSX Formatter** first (chapter 6).
- ✓ The **images** named in the workbook have been uploaded to the Image Library, and the names match exactly (chapter 4).
- ✓ Any **tables** pasted into the workbook are valid table JSON (chapter 5).
- ✓ The workbook is **saved** in Excel after your last change (closing it is even safer), so the website reads the latest version.

3.2 Step 1 — Choose your workbook

Open **Create PDFs**. You will see a large drop area on the left and the three-step guide on the right.

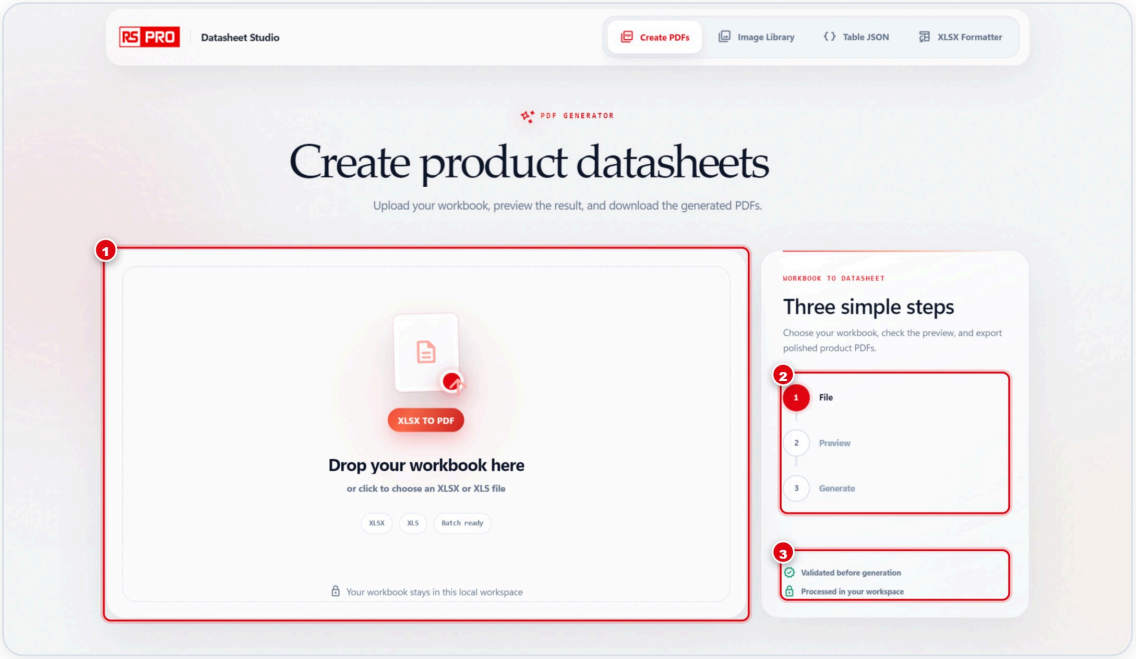


Figure 2. The Create PDFs start screen, waiting for a workbook.

1. **Drop area** — drag your workbook onto it, or click anywhere inside it and choose the file. Only `.xlsx` and `.xls` files are accepted.
2. **Step tracker** — shows *File*, *Preview* and *Generate*. The current step is highlighted in red; finished steps show a tick.
3. **Reminders** — the workbook is checked before generation, and you can preview before you export.

If you pick the wrong kind of file

A message appears: “Please choose an XLSX or XLS spreadsheet file.” Nothing is lost — simply choose the correct file.

3.3 Step 2 — Check the file and choose the header layout

As soon as the file is chosen, the drop area is replaced by a card that confirms what you loaded and lets you decide how the top of each PDF should look.

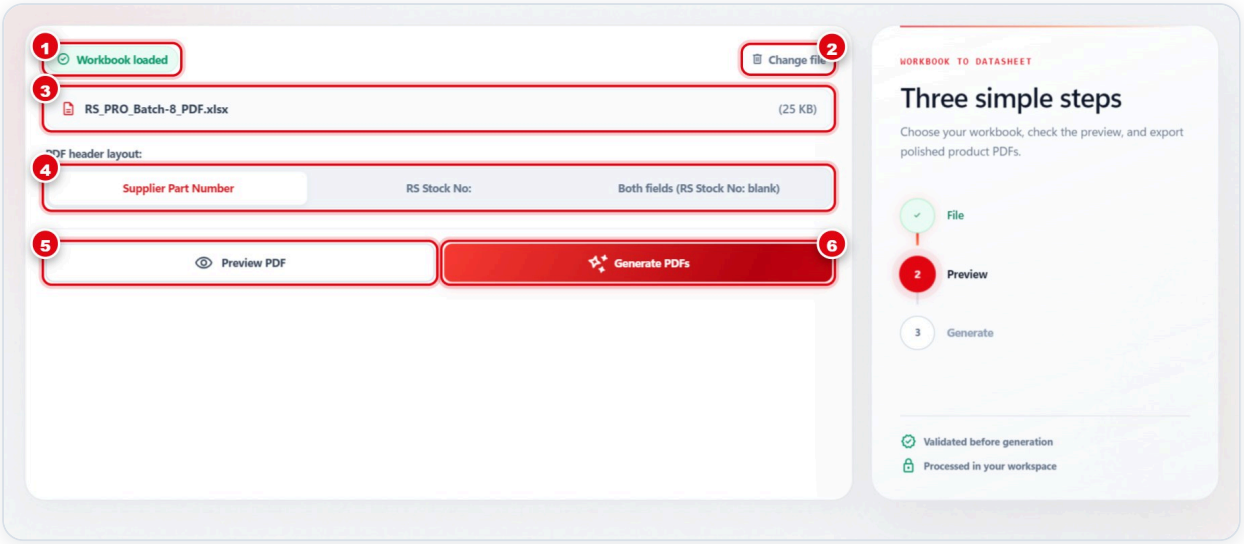


Figure 3. The card shown after a workbook is loaded.

1. **Workbook loaded** — green confirmation badge.
2. **Change file** — removes this workbook so you can choose another.
3. **File name and size** — check you picked the right file.
4. **PDF header layout** — chooses which part-number line is printed under the product title (see below).
5. **Preview PDF** — shows the first product as a PDF before you commit.
6. **Generate PDFs** — builds every product in the workbook.

The three header layouts

Under each product title the PDF prints a line with the product code. You choose which one:



Figure 4. The same product with each header layout. Only the lines under the title change.

Option	What is printed	Use it when
Supplier Part Number	`Supplier Part Number: SA1210/P2IG-NP` (the stock number from the workbook)	You want the supplier's code on the sheet. This is the default.
RS Stock No:	`RS Stock No:` followed by the RS stock number, if the workbook has one	The datasheet should show the RS stock code only.
Both fields (RS Stock No: blank)	Both lines. The RS Stock No line is left empty so it can be completed later.	The RS number is not known yet.

> ★ **Tip**
> Changing the layout closes any open preview. Click **Preview PDF** again to see the new layout before generating.

3.4 Step 3 — Preview the first datasheet

Click **Preview PDF**. After a few seconds a preview panel opens below, showing the complete datasheet for the **first product row** of your workbook. Always preview before generating: if the first product looks right, the rest of the batch will follow the same layout.

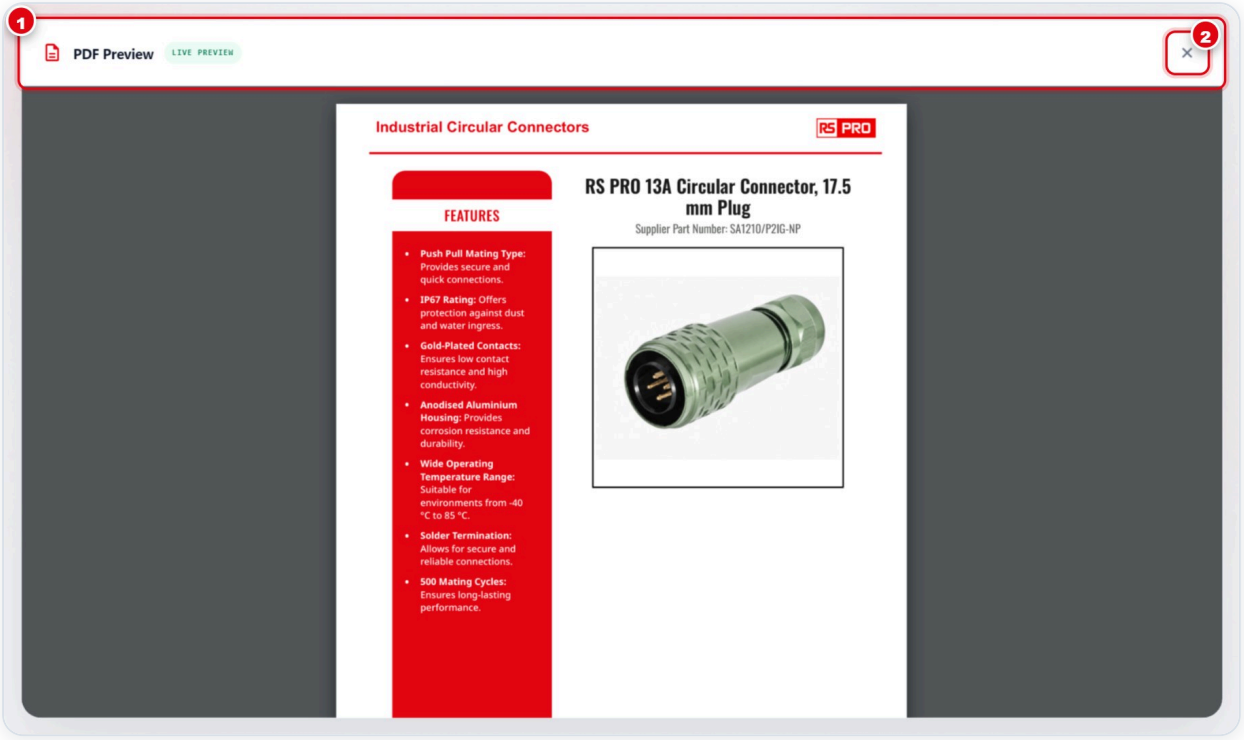


Figure 5. The preview panel. (Your browser draws its own PDF viewer inside this panel, with page controls and zoom.)

1. **Preview bar** — confirms this is a live preview.
2. **Close** (×) — hides the preview. Your workbook stays loaded.

Things worth checking in the preview:

- ✓ The product photo appears inside the frame (an empty frame means the image name does not match — see chapter 4).
- ✓ Feature bullets read correctly and are not cut off.
- ✓ Every specification table is present, with the right headings and values.

✓ The header layout is the one you chose.

3.5 Step 4 — Generate the PDFs

Click **Generate PDFs**. The website first runs a quick **duplicate check**, then builds the files.

The duplicate check

A specification is a *duplicate* when the same attribute with the same value appears more than once for one product — for example *Current: 13 A* listed in both the Electrical and Approvals tables. Duplicates make a datasheet look careless, so generation pauses and shows them to you.

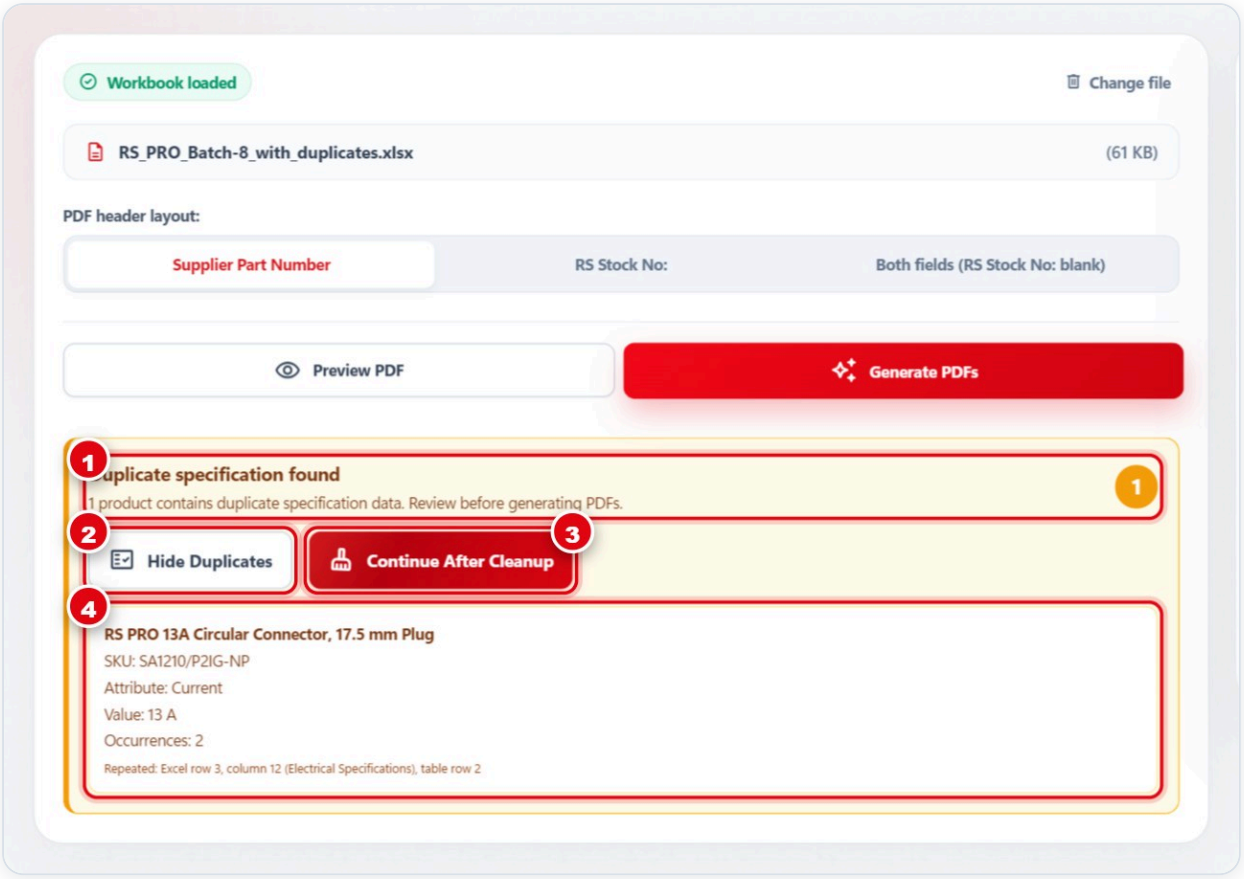


Figure 6. The duplicate warning. Here the attribute *Current = 13 A* appears twice for one product.

1. **Summary** — how many products contain duplicates; the orange badge is the number of duplicated specifications.
2. **Review Duplicates / Hide Duplicates** — shows or hides the detailed list.
3. **Continue After Cleanup** — generates the PDFs but keeps only the first copy of each repeated specification.
4. **Detail card** — product name, SKU, attribute, value, how many times it occurs, and the exact workbook location of the repeats (row, column and table row).

> ! **Two ways to deal with duplicates**
>
> **Fix the workbook** (best): remove the repeated line in Excel, save, and load the file again. **Or click Continue After Cleanup** to leave the repeats out of the PDF only. Your workbook file itself is never changed.

> **If a product fails to build**
> If any product cannot be built, the job is reported as failed and a message is shown. Preview the first product, fix the problem in the workbook, and try again. Chapter 8 lists the most common causes.

Progress

If there are no duplicates (or after you choose cleanup), the progress screen appears. Keep this browser tab open until it finishes.

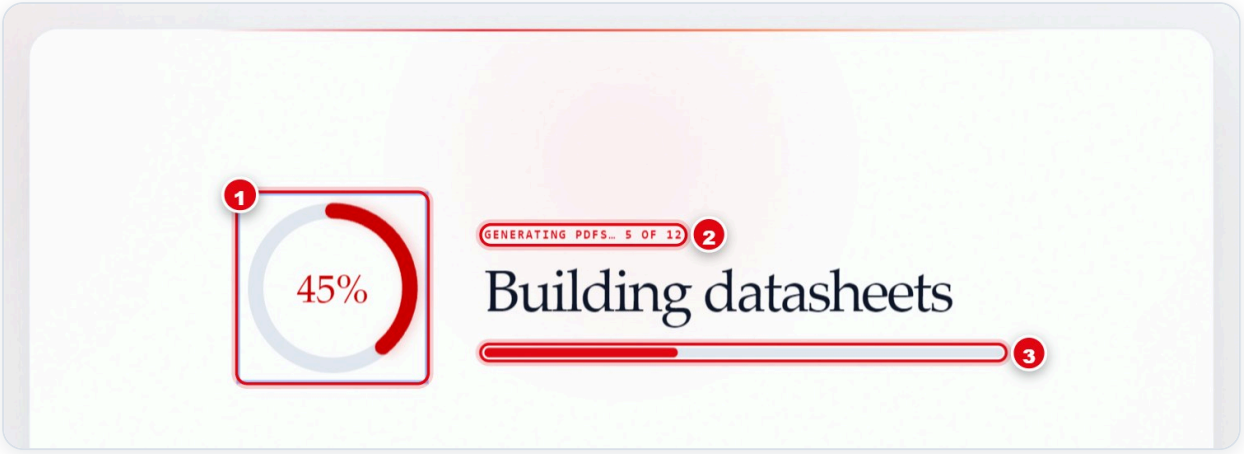


Figure 7. PDFs being built, one after another.

1. **Progress ring** — overall percentage.
2. **Counter** — for example *Generating PDFs… 8 of 12*.
3. **Progress bar** — the same progress as a bar.

Finished

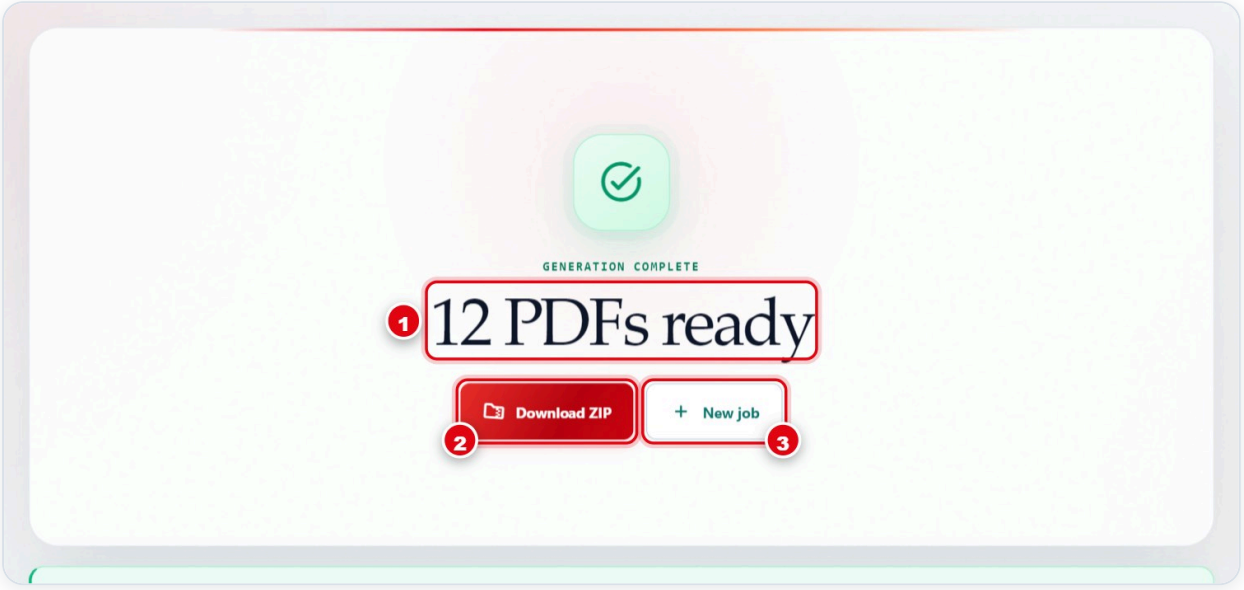


Figure 8. The completion screen.

1. **Result** — how many PDFs were produced.
2. **Download ZIP** (or **Download PDF** when there is only one) — downloads again if you need it.
3. **New job** — clears the screen so you can start another workbook.

> **Automatic download**
> When generation finishes the browser downloads the result for you straight away: one PDF if the workbook has one product, otherwise a ZIP named after your workbook.

3.6 What the finished PDF looks like

Every product gets a consistent, branded layout. The example below is the real output for the first product in the sample workbook: a cover page with features and the main photo, followed by specification tables.

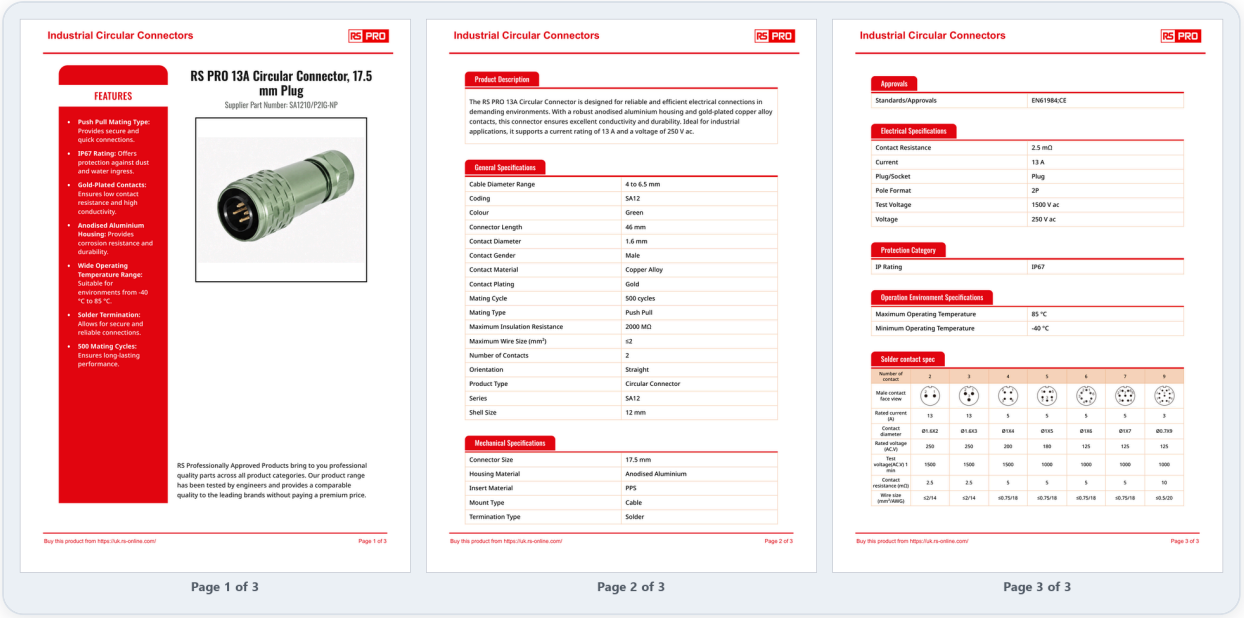


Figure 9. A three-page datasheet produced from one workbook row.

Part of the page	Where the information comes from
Top-left heading and RS PRO logo	The *Product Common Name* column
Product title	The *Cover Page Title* column
Part-number line(s)	The *RS Stock No* column and your header layout choice
Red FEATURES panel	The *Features* column (an HTML bullet list)
Main photo in the frame	The *Cover Image* column, matched to the Image Library
Paragraph at the bottom of page 1	The *Cover Tagline* column; when empty, a standard RS Professionally Approved paragraph is used
Red section tabs and tables	Every other column, in the same left-to-right order as in the workbook
Footer	"Buy this product from…" link and automatic page numbers

3.7 PDF file names

Each PDF is named after the product's stock number, with any `/` or space changed to an underscore:

Stock number in the workbook	PDF file name
`SA1210/P2IG-NP`	`SA1210_P2IG-NP.pdf`
`SA2010/P12IIG-1-NP`	`SA2010_P12IIG-1-NP.pdf`
`ES-CGD-275-RS`	`ES-CGD-275-RS.pdf`

Stop — do not repeat a stock number

If two rows have the same stock number, the second PDF **overwrites** the first one. Make sure every row has a unique stock number. Generating again with the same stock numbers also replaces the earlier PDFs.

CHAPTER 4

4 Image Library

The Image Library is the shared store of product photos and diagrams. The PDF generator finds pictures here by **file name**, so getting the names right is the single most important habit.

4.1 How images reach the PDF

Your workbook never contains the pictures themselves — only their **names**. When a PDF is built, the website looks for a file with that name in the library and places it on the page.



If the name does not match

The PDF is still produced, but the photo frame is **empty** (just a black outline). No error message is shown, so always check the preview.

4.2 The library screen

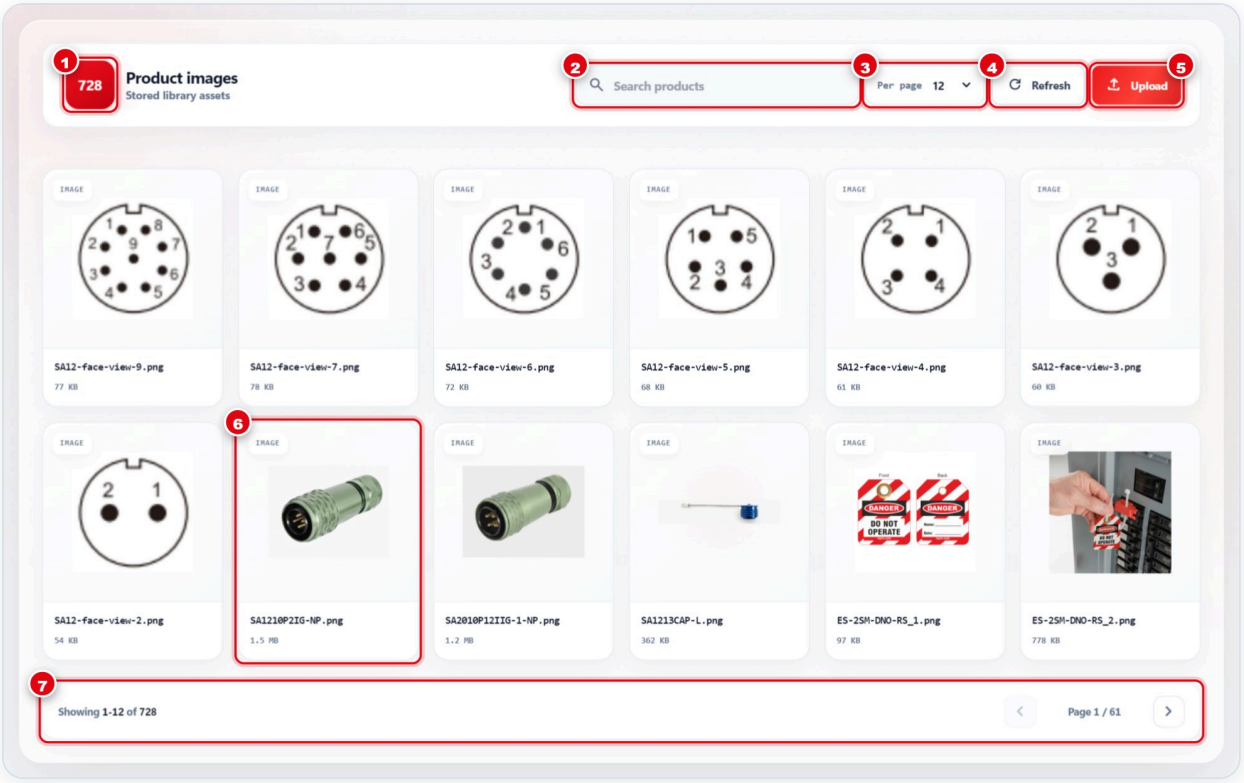


Figure 10. The Image Library showing the first 12 of 728 stored images.

1. **Image counter** — the total number of images stored (or found by a search).
2. **Search products** — type part of a file name to filter the list.
3. **Per page** — how many images to show at once: 12, 24, 48 or 96.
4. **Refresh** — reloads the list.
5. **Upload** — add new images (you can choose many at once).
6. **Image card** — thumbnail, file name and file size. Hover over a card to reveal its tools (section 4.5).
7. **Page bar** — shows which images you are looking at and lets you move between pages.

4.3 Upload images

1. Click the red **Upload** button (callout 5 above).
2. In the file window select one or many image files. Hold `Ctrl` or `Shift` to select several. Pictures (PNG, JPG, WEBP, GIF and similar) are accepted; other file types are ignored.
3. The button shows progress as *uploaded / total*. When finished, a message such as *"12 images uploaded."* appears and the list refreshes.

Large batches are sent in groups of 50, so even hundreds of images upload without trouble.

File name rules

The library **cleans every name on upload**: folders are dropped, and anything other than letters, numbers, dot, hyphen and underscore becomes an underscore. For example, `Product Photo (1).jpg` is stored as `Product_Photo__1_.jpg`.

Good names	Names that cause trouble
✓ `SA1210P2IG-NP.png` ✓ `ES-CGD-275-RS_1.png` ✓ `0291604_2.jpg`	✗ `SA1210 P2IG (final).png` — spaces and brackets change to underscores ✗ `sa1210p2ig-np.PNG.png` — double extension ✗ names that differ from the workbook by even one character

> **Same name = replaced**
> Uploading a file with a name that already exists **silently replaces** the stored image. This is handy for fixing a picture, but make sure you really mean it.

4.4 Find an image

Type in the search box. The list narrows to every file whose name contains your text. Typing `SA12` finds all the SA12-series pictures at once.

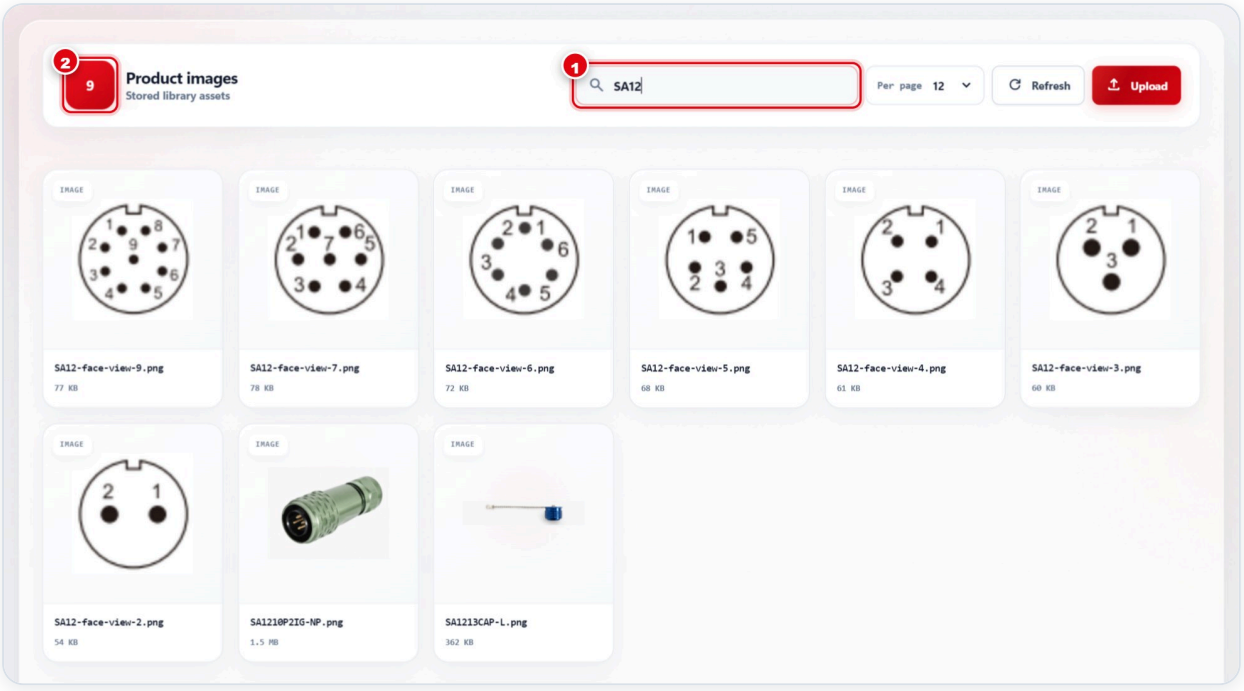


Figure 11. Searching for `SA12` leaves 9 images. The counter shows the number of matches.

1. **Search box** — results update as you type.
2. **Counter** — changes from the total to the number of matches.

4.5 Copy, download, rename or delete

Move the mouse over any card to show a small toolbar with four buttons.

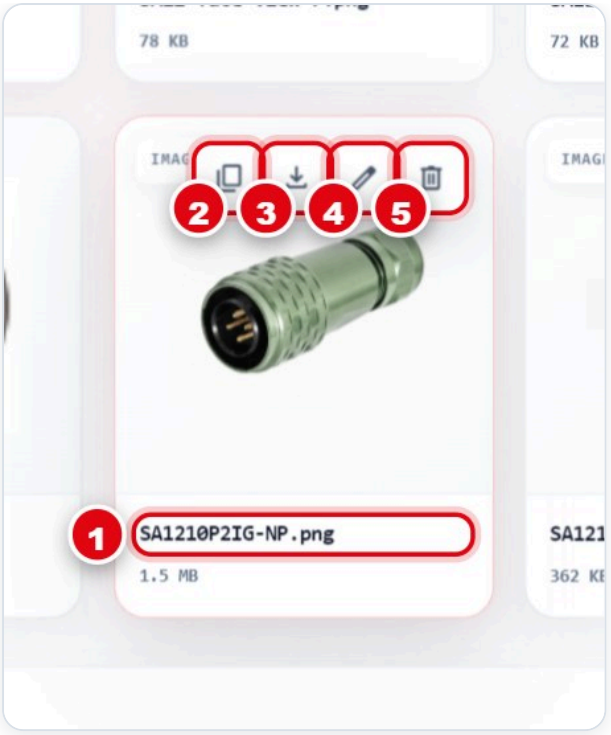


Figure 12. Tools appear when you hover over a card.

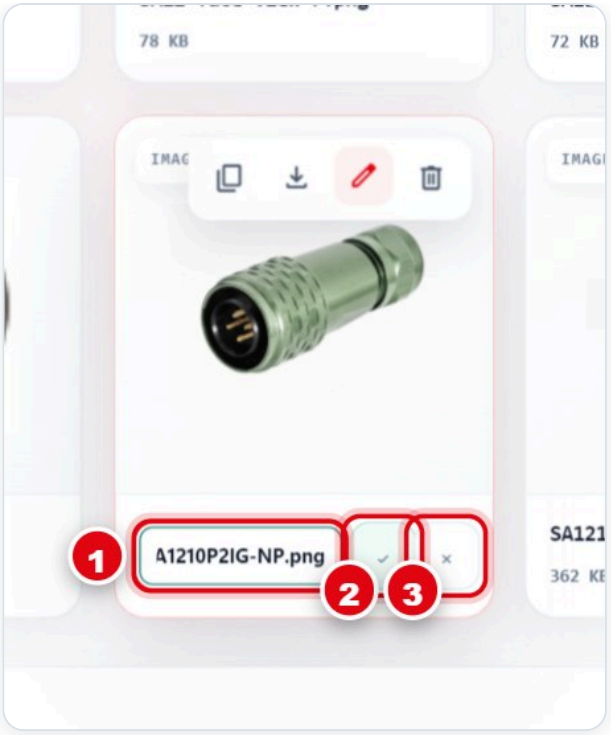


Figure 13. Rename mode after clicking the pencil.

#	Button	What it does
1	File name	The stored name — copy it into the workbook exactly as shown.
2	Copy link	Copies the picture's web address (link) and shows "Image link copied."
3	Download	Saves the image to your computer.
4	Rename (pencil)	Turns the name into a text box. In the second picture: **1** is the editable name, **2** (tick) or `Enter` saves, **3** (cross) or `Esc` cancels. A blank name is refused.
5	Delete (bin)	Asks "Delete *name*?" and, if you confirm, removes the picture from the library for good.

Stop — renaming or deleting breaks workbook links

If a workbook still uses the old name, its PDFs will show an empty photo frame. After renaming or deleting, update the name in the workbook.

4.6 Matching names in the workbook

In the workbook, an image cell may contain the bare file name, a path, or a full web address. **Only the last part — the file name — is used**, so these three are equivalent:

`SA1210P2IG-NP.png` = `/SA1210P2IG-NP.png` = a full web address ending in `/SA1210P2IG-NP.png`

The name must match the library **letter for letter, including the file extension**. This is the most common cause of an empty photo frame. A real example from the sample workbook:

Product	Name in the workbook	Name in the library	Result
SA1210/P2IG-NP	`/SA1210P2IG-NP.png`	`SA1210P2IG-NP.png`	✓ **Photo appears**
SA2010/P12IIG-1-NP	`/SA2010_P12IIG-1-NP.png`	`SA2010P12IIG-1-NP.png`	✗ **Extra underscore — frame is empty**
SA1213CAP-L	`/SA1213CAP-L.jpg`	`SA1213CAP-L.png`	✗ `.jpg` **vs** `.png` **— frame is empty**

★ **Tip — a 30-second check before every batch**
Search the library for the first few letters of each product code and compare the names with the workbook. Then run **Preview PDF**: a filled photo frame proves the match works.

CHAPTER 5

5 Table JSON

Specification tables in a datasheet are stored in the workbook as small pieces of text called **table JSON**. This tool reads a table from a PDF or picture and writes that text for you, so nobody has to type tables by hand.

5.1 What is table JSON?

JSON is a simple way of writing structured data as text. For a datasheet table it has three parts. The example below is a real one, shortened, together with the table it produces in the PDF.

```
{"section":"Solder contact spec",
 "headers":["Number of contact","2","3","4", … ,"9"],
 "rows":[
   ["Male contact face view","/SA12-face-view-2.png", … ],
   ["Rated current (A)","13","13","5","5","5","5","3"],
   ["Contact diameter","Ø1.6X2","Ø1.6X3", … ,"Ø0.7X9"],
   …
 ]}
```

Solder contact spec

Number of contact	2	3	4	5	6	7	9
Male contact face view							
Rated current (A)	13	13	5	5	5	5	3
Contact diameter	Ø1.6X2	Ø1.6X3	Ø1X4	Ø1X5	Ø1X6	Ø1X7	Ø0.7X9
Rated voltage (AC.V)	250	250	200	180	125	125	125
Test voltage(AC.V) 1 min	1500	1500	1500	1000	1000	1000	1000
Contact resistance (mΩ)	2.5	2.5	5	5	5	5	10
Wire size (mm²/AWG)	≤2/14	≤2/14	≤0.75/18	≤0.75/18	≤0.75/18	≤0.75/18	≤0.5/20

Figure 14. The PDF table created from the JSON above.

Part	Meaning
`section`	The title shown on the red tab above the table.
`headers`	The shaded first row of the table, one entry per column.
`rows`	The body of the table. Each row is a list with exactly one entry per column.

Two-column tables (a label and a value) can also be written in a simpler form, which the Formatter creates automatically for specification groups:

```
{"section":"Approvals","headers":[],"rows":[{"label":"Standards/Approvals","value":"EN61984;CE"}]}
```


> **You never have to write this yourself**
> The tool creates the text. You only review it. The rest of this chapter shows how.

5.2 Manual crop — one table at a time

Use **Manual crop** when you want one particular table from a PDF page or a screenshot. You choose the area, so you stay in control.

Step 1 — Open the tool and choose a file

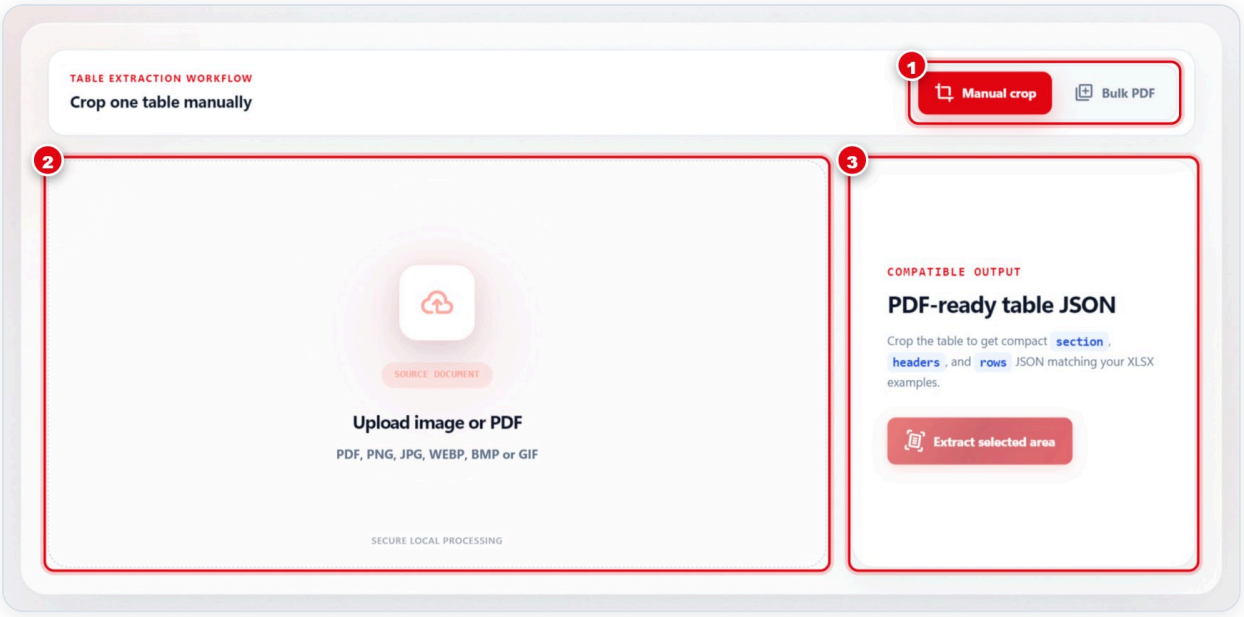


Figure 15. The Table JSON start screen in Manual crop mode.

1. **Mode switch** — *Manual crop* (one table, you choose the area) or *Bulk PDF* (many PDFs, automatic — see section 5.6).
2. **Drop area** — drag a PDF or picture here, or click to browse. Accepted: PDF, PNG, JPG, WEBP, BMP, GIF.
3. **Output panel** — describes the result. After an extraction it also shows the page, the reading method (*PDF text* or *OCR*) and, for OCR, a confidence percentage.

Step 2 — Select the table

The page appears in a large preview. For a multi-page PDF use the arrows at the top right (*Page 2 / 5*) to find the page. Then **drag from one corner of the table to the opposite corner**. A red box with white handles appears.

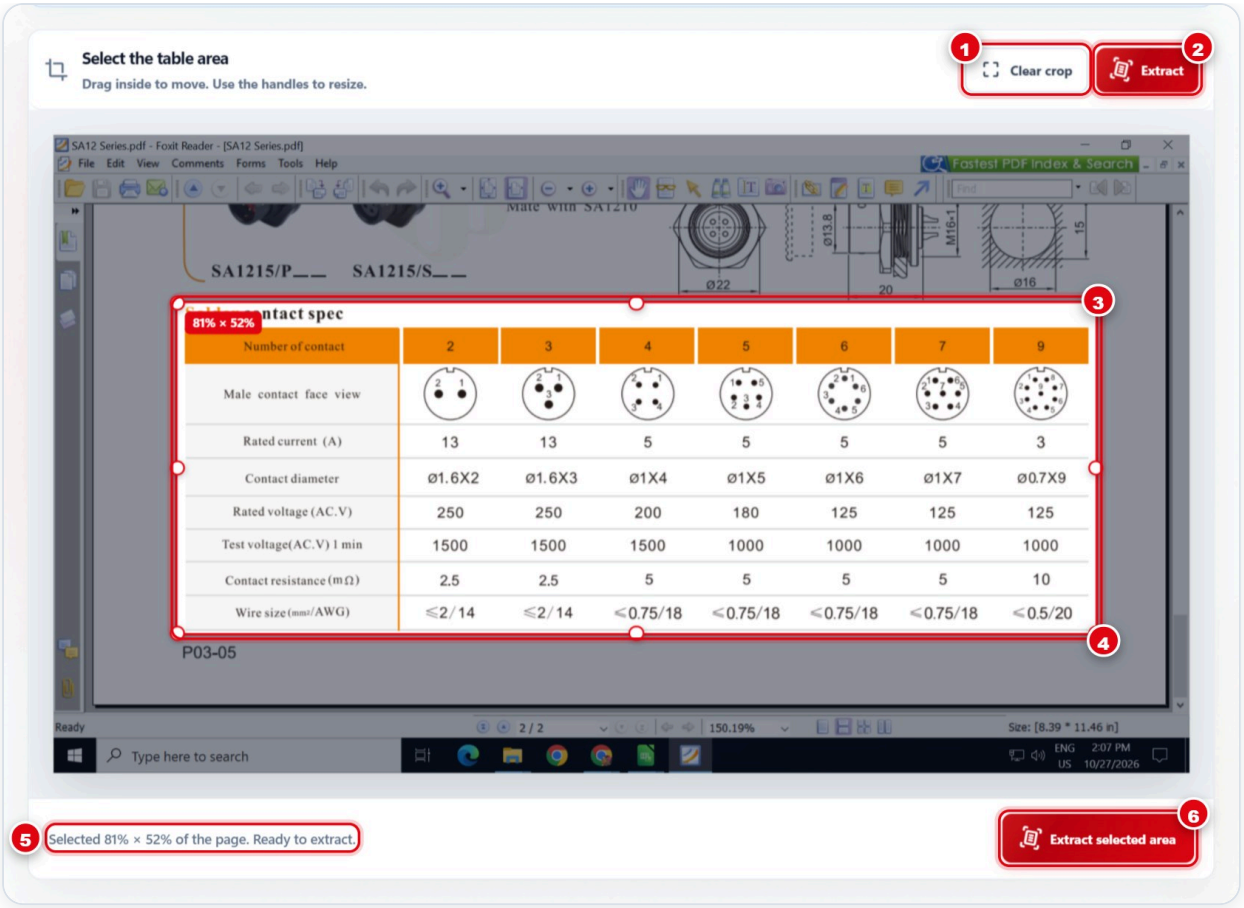


Figure 16. A table selected on a screenshot of a supplier PDF.

1. **Clear crop** — removes the selection so you can draw again.
2. **Extract** — starts reading the selected area (same as button 6).
3. **Selected area** — drag inside it to move it. The label shows its size as a percentage of the page.
4. **Handles** — drag any white dot to resize.
5. **Status line** — says whether a selection exists. Errors appear here in red.
6. **Extract selected area** — the same action, placed where your mouse already is, so you never need to scroll up.

Step 3 — Extract and review

Click either **Extract** button. The page then scrolls down to the result by itself.

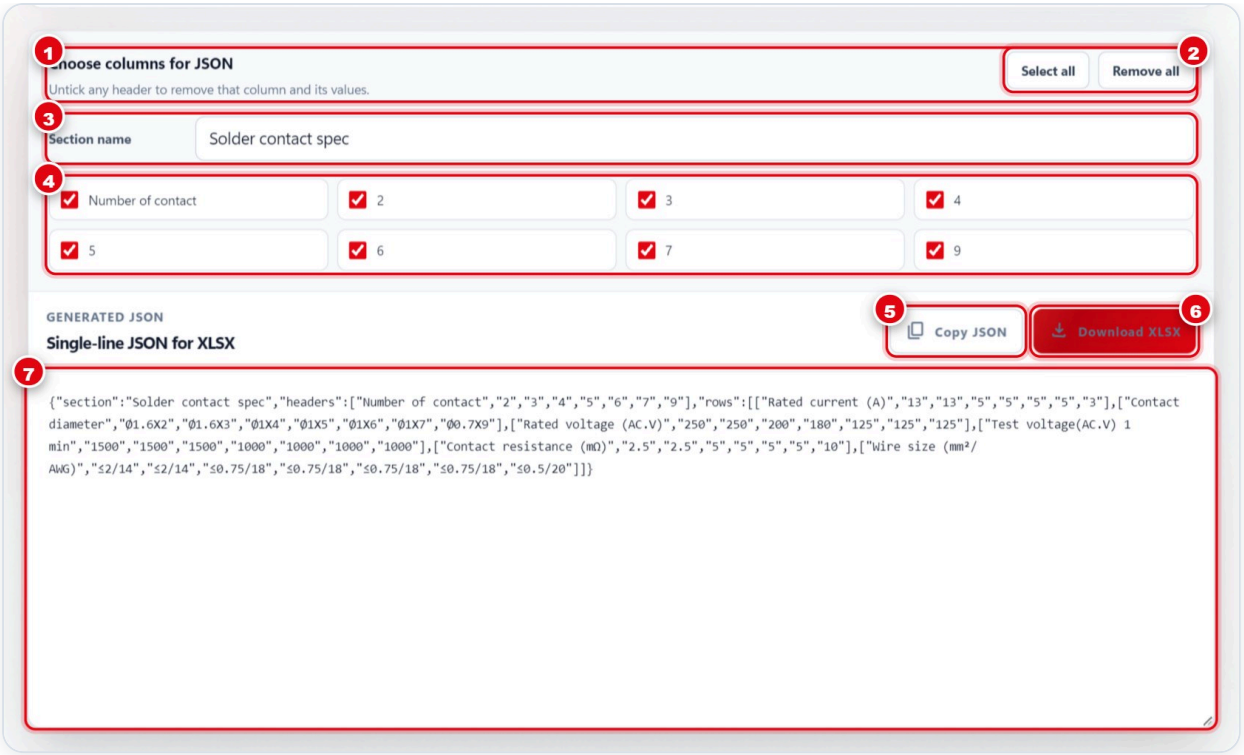


Figure 17. The result: choose columns, check the section name, and copy the JSON.

1. **Choose columns for JSON** — every extracted column is listed with a tick box.
2. **Select all / Remove all** — tick or untick every column at once.
3. **Section name** — the title for the red tab. Edit it freely; the JSON updates immediately.
4. **Column boxes** — untick a header to remove that whole column and its values from the JSON.
5. **Copy JSON** — copies the text to the clipboard. A message reads "JSON copied. Paste it directly into a JSON table column in the XLSX."
6. **Download XLSX** — saves a small workbook containing the JSON in a `variant_json` column.
7. **JSON text** — the final single-line JSON. You can click in it and correct any value by hand.

> **If the JSON text is edited badly**
> Copy and Download check the text first. If a quote or bracket was deleted by accident you will see "Fix the JSON syntax before copying or downloading." Undo your edit, or re-extract.

5.3 Tips for accurate results

Select the whole table

Include the header row and every data row, but not the surrounding text. At least a header and two rows are needed.

Use the best source

A real PDF is read exactly. A screenshot or scan needs OCR (text recognition), which can misread small characters.

Zoom before you screenshot

Sharp, straight, high-resolution screenshots give the best OCR. Avoid shadows, angles and compression.

Always check the numbers

Compare the JSON text with the source. Look especially at decimal points and symbols such as Ø, ≤, Ω, mm^2.

What you notice	What to do
Section name is wrong or blank	The title above the table was cut off. Type the correct name in **Section name**, or crop slightly higher.
An unwanted column appears	Untick it in **Choose columns**.
One value is wrong	Fix it directly in the JSON text box.
"No table could be detected"	Select a larger area including the header, or use a sharper picture.
Table spans two pages	Extract each page separately and join the rows in one JSON, or keep them as two tables.

What the tool handles for you

Coloured header bands (orange or red with light text), tables with a pin-diagram row, and common symbols (Ø, ≤, Ω, mm^2) are recognised automatically. Pictures inside a table cannot be read as text — see section 5.5.

5.4 Put the JSON into your workbook

1. In Table JSON, click **Copy JSON**.
2. Open the uniform workbook in Excel and find the product's row.
3. Click the cell in the table column you want (a column whose top header cell says `variant_json`). Add a new column with that header if you need one more table.
4. Press `Ctrl` + `V` to paste. The whole JSON stays on one line in the cell.
5. Save the workbook and use **Preview PDF** to confirm the table looks right.

Column order = page order

Tables appear in the PDF in the same left-to-right order as their columns in the workbook. Drag columns in Excel to change the order of tables on the page.

5.5 Tables that contain pictures

Some supplier tables include small drawings, such as a *contact face view* showing the pin layout. A drawing is a picture, so the tool cannot turn it into text; that row is left out. You add it yourself in three steps:

1. Crop each drawing from the source and upload it to the **Image Library** with a clear name, for example `SA12-face-view-2.png`, `SA12-face-view-3.png`, and so on.

2. In the JSON, add a row whose first entry is the label and whose other entries are the image file names, in column order:

```
["Male contact face view","/SA12-face-view-2.png","/SA12-face-view-3.png", … ]
```

3. Preview the PDF. Each file name is replaced by the picture, shown at a small, uniform height inside its cell (see the table in section 5.1).

> **Important**
> Image names inside a table follow the same rules as chapter 4: exact spelling, correct extension, uploaded first.

5.6 Bulk PDF — many PDFs at once

Switch the mode to **Bulk PDF** when you have a whole folder of supplier PDFs and want their tables without cropping each one. The tool reads every page and finds tables automatically.

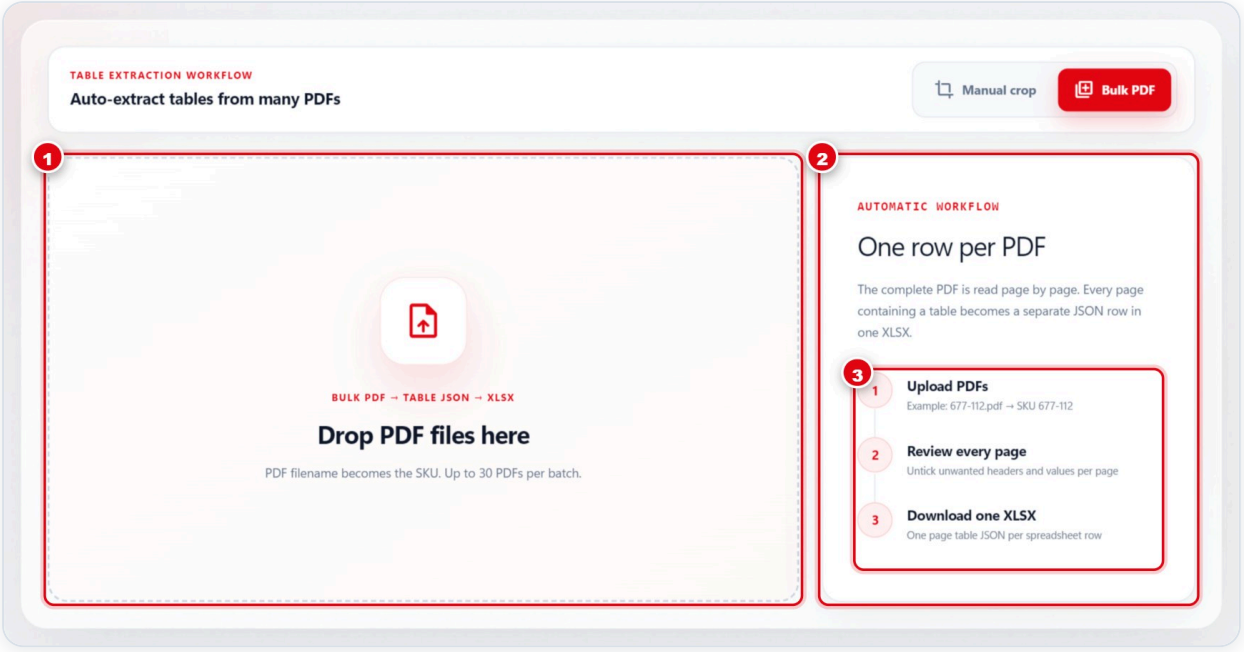


Figure 18. Bulk PDF mode, before any files are loaded.

1. **Drop area** — drop up to **30 PDF files** (80 MB each). Only PDFs are accepted in this mode.
2. **Guide panel** — the three steps in short.
3. **Flow list** — upload → review every page → download one XLSX. The **PDF file name becomes the SKU**: `677-112.pdf` becomes `677-112`.

After the files are dropped, the website says it is “Automatically finding tables…” and then shows a review screen.

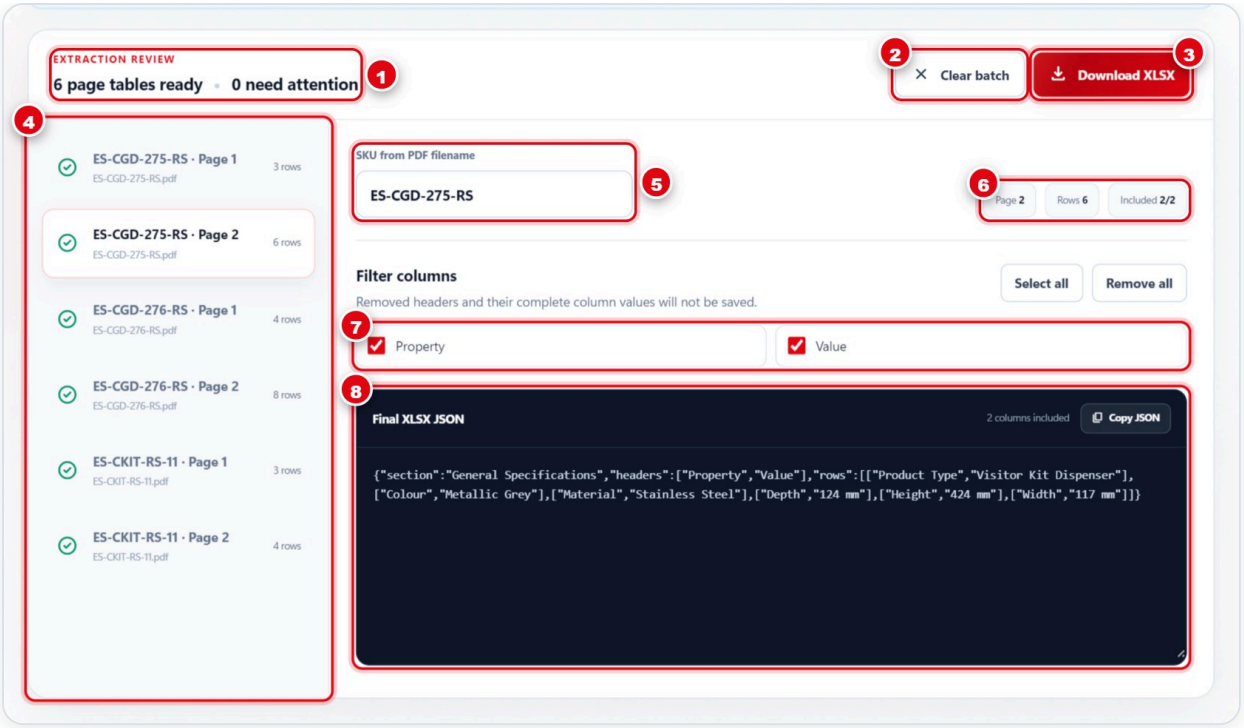


Figure 19. The review screen. Each table found on each page is a separate entry.

1. **Summary** — how many page tables are ready and how many need attention.
2. **Clear batch** — throws away all results to start again.
3. **Download XLSX** — saves one workbook with one row per table found.
4. **File list** — one entry per PDF page, with a green tick (ready) or a warning sign, and the number of rows. Click an entry to inspect it.
5. **SKU field** — taken from the file name; edit it if it is not the right product code.
6. **Facts** — page number, row count, and how many columns are included.
7. **Column filters** — untick unwanted columns for this entry only.
8. **Final JSON** — exactly what will be saved. **Copy JSON** copies it.

The downloaded workbook `Page_by_Page_Table_JSON.xlsx` has two sheets: *PDF Ready JSON* (SKU, source PDF, source page, JSON — ready to copy into your uniform workbook) and *Extraction Review* (the same rows with section and column details, for checking).

> **Always review**
> Bulk mode finds *every* table-like block, including ones you may not need, such as a two-column list of general properties. Check each entry, and delete rows you do not want in Excel. Entries marked **need attention** could not be read — use **Manual crop** for those PDFs.

> **Scanned PDFs**
> A PDF with real text is read exactly. A scanned PDF (a picture of a page) is read with OCR, only for its first ten pages, and may need more checking.

CHAPTER 6

6 XLSX Formatter

Suppliers send workbooks in their own style. The XLSX Formatter converts one into the exact structure the PDF generator expects — the **uniform workbook** — without retyping.

6.1 What your supplier workbook must contain

The Formatter reads the **first worksheet** of the file. Row 1 must hold the column titles and there must be at least one product row below it. These columns are **required**; the names are matched even if capital letters or spacing differ:

Required column	Other names it also accepts
Supplier Part Number	RS Stock No, Stock No, SKU
Header	Product Common Name, Common Name
Title	Cover Page Title, Product Title
Description	Product Description
Image	Cover Image
Features	Feature List

Optional columns that are used when present: `Additional Image 1` to `Additional Image 5`, `Drawing Image` (or `Line Diagram`), and any number of **attribute triples**:

Column	Example value
`Attribute Name 1`	Cable Diameter Range
`Attribute Value 1`	4 to 6.5 mm
`Attribute Group 1`	General Specifications

Number the triples 1, 2, 3… as far as you need. Every other column you add is kept and carried across as an extra field.

> **If a required column is missing**
> The Formatter stops with a message such as “Required source headers are missing: Features”. Add or rename the column in your file and try again.

6.2 Step by step

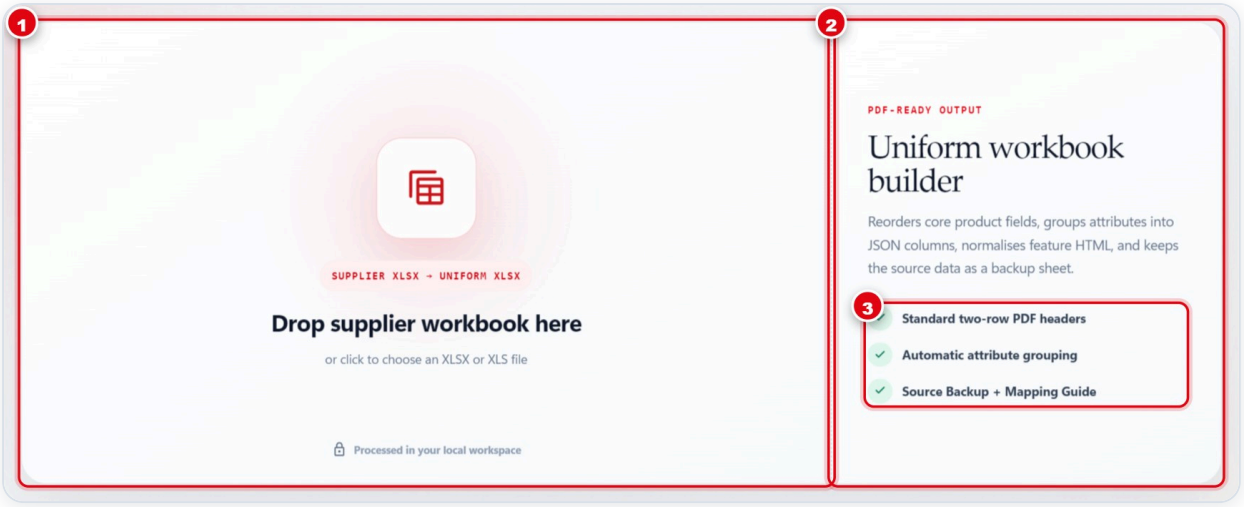


Figure 20. The Formatter before a file is chosen.

1. **Drop area** — drop the supplier workbook here or click to choose it (XLSX or XLS, up to 60 MB).
2. **Output panel** — explains the result: standard two-row headers, automatic grouping of attributes, and a backup of the source data.
3. **Checklist** — what the converted workbook will contain.

As soon as you choose the file it is analysed (a spinner shows briefly) and the screen fills with a summary and a preview.

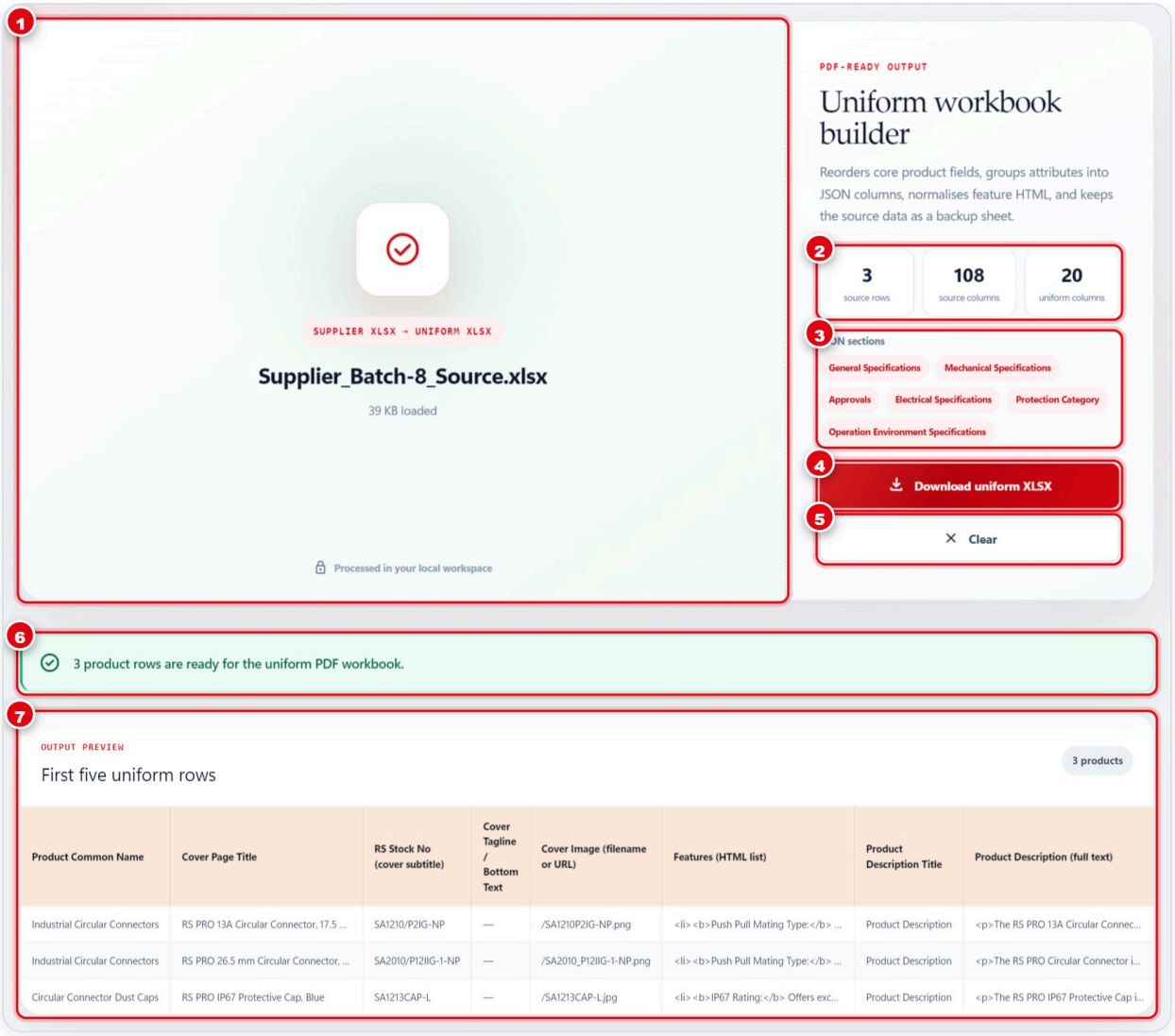


Figure 21. A supplier workbook analysed and ready to download.

1. **Loaded file** — shows the file name and size.
2. **Counts** — source rows (products), source columns, and the number of columns in the new workbook.
3. **JSON sections** — the specification groups found in the attributes, each becoming one table column.
4. **Download uniform XLSX** — builds and saves the new workbook, named `<your file>_PDF_Ready.xlsx`.
5. **Clear** — discards this file so you can start with another.
6. **Success message** — for example "3 product rows are ready for the uniform PDF workbook."
7. **Output preview** — the first five products in the new layout. Scroll sideways to see every column.

Check the preview before downloading

Look at the *Cover Image* column in the preview. Names such as `/SA2010_P12IIG-1-NP.png` and `/SA1213CAP-L.jpg` are copied exactly as the supplier wrote them — make sure they match what is in the Image Library (chapter 4).

6.3 What the downloaded workbook contains

Sheet	Contents
Uniform Data	The PDF-ready sheet: two header rows, then one row per product. Attributes are grouped into one JSON table column per group (General, Mechanical, Approvals…). Feature text is tidied into a bullet list. Six image columns are added. This must stay the **first sheet**.
Source Backup	An untouched copy of the supplier data.
Mapping Guide	A list showing which supplier column feeds which PDF column.

What to do next

Open the new workbook and add anything the supplier did not provide: extra tables (chapter 5), a cover tagline, and any missing images (chapter 4). Then generate the PDFs (chapter 3).

CHAPTER 7

7 The workbook explained

Everything the PDF generator needs is in one worksheet. This chapter is a reference you can keep open while you edit the workbook.

7.1 Two header rows, one product per row

The workbook's **first worksheet** (named *Uniform Data*) is read. Row 1 holds a short technical name for each column — its **role**. Row 2 holds a human-friendly **label**. Product data starts on row 3, with **one product per row**.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
1	common_name	cover_title	stock_no	cover_tagline	cover_image	feature_list	description_title	description	variant_json	variant_json	image	image
2	Product Common Name	Cover Page Title	RS Stock No	Cover Tagline	Cover Image	Features (HTML)	Description Title	Description	General Specs (JSON)	Approvals (JSON)	Additional Image 1	Drawing Image
3	Industrial Circular Connectors	RS PRO 13A Circular Connector, 17.5 mm Plug	SA1210/P2IG-NP		/SA1210P2IG-NP.png	<b>Push Pull...	Product Description	<p>The RS PRO 13A...	{"section":"General...	{"section":"Approvals"...		
4	Circular Connector Dust Caps	RS PRO IP67 Protective Cap, Blue	SA1213CAP-L		/SA1213CAP-L.png	<b>IP67...	Product Description	<p>The RS PRO IP67...	{"section":"General...			

A simplified view of a uniform workbook. Row 1 (red) = roles, row 2 (peach) = labels, rows 3 onward = products. Yellow cells hold image file names.

> **Other header styles**
> The website also recognises a single row of plain titles (such as *Supplier Part Number* and *Features*) and maps them for you. The two-row layout, which the XLSX Formatter creates, is the safest and most predictable.

7.2 Column guide

Role (row 1)	Label (row 2)	What to enter	Where it appears in the PDF
`common_name`	Product Common Name	The product family or category	Heading at the top of every page
`cover_title`	Cover Page Title	The full product title	Large title on page 1
`stock_no`	RS Stock No (cover subtitle)	The product code. Must be **unique**.	Part-number line; also the PDF file name
`cover_tagline`	Cover Tagline / Bottom Text	Optional closing sentence	Bottom of page 1. If empty, the standard RS Professionally Approved paragraph is used
`cover_image`	Cover Image	Main picture **file name**	Framed photo on page 1

`feature_list`	Features (HTML list)	Bullets written as `<li><b>Title:</b> text</li>`	Red FEATURES panel on page 1
`description_title`	Product Description Title	Heading for the description	Red tab above the description
`description`	Product Description	Paragraph text, usually inside `<p>…</p>`	Text block after the cover
`variant_json`	Any name ending (JSON)	One table JSON per cell. Add as many columns as you need.	A red tab plus a formatted table
`image`	Additional Image 1–5, Drawing Image	Picture **file names**	Picture frames after the tables; the drawing image comes last

7.3 What each kind of cell may contain

Kind	Rules	Example
Plain text	Typed as it should appear.	`RS PRO 13A Circular Connector`
Features list	Several `<li>` items in one cell, with a bold lead-in and a colon. No outer list tag is needed.	`<li><b>IP67 Rating:</b> Offers protection</li>`
Description	Simple HTML such as `<p>`, `<b>`.	`<p>The connector is designed for…</p>`
Table JSON	Starts with `{` and follows the format in section 5.1. Invalid JSON is shown as plain text instead of a table.	`{"section":"Approvals","headers":[],"rows":[…]}`
Image name	File name, path or web address ending in an image extension. Must exist in the Image Library.	`/SA1210P2IG-NP.png`
Empty cell	Skipped completely — no empty heading or table is printed.	

7.4 Order of sections

After the cover items, **every remaining column becomes one section, in the same left-to-right order as the columns**. To print Approvals before Electrical Specifications, move the Approvals column to the left of it. A table's red tab shows the `section` text inside its JSON; if there is none, the column label is used.

7.5 Do and don’t

Do

- ✓ Keep *Uniform Data* as the first sheet.
- ✓ Use two header rows and one product per row.
- ✓ Give every product a unique stock number.
- ✓ Copy image names from the Image Library.
- ✓ Save as `.xlsx` before uploading.
- ✓ Preview the first product every time.

Don’t

- ✗ Insert extra rows above the header rows.
- ✗ Merge cells inside the data area.
- ✗ Rename the role cells in row 1.
- ✗ Rely on hidden rows or columns to hide content — they are still read.
- ✗ Use the same stock number twice.
- ✗ Paste JSON that has been split over several cells.

CHAPTER 8

8 Troubleshooting

Find what you see in the left column, then follow the fix on the right.

8.1 Quick fixes

What you see	Most likely reason	What to do
The page will not load, lists are empty, or buttons do nothing	A temporary connection problem, or the service is briefly unavailable.	Refresh the page (`F5`). If it still fails, contact support with a screenshot.
The photo frame on the PDF is empty	The image name in the workbook does not match the library (spelling, underscore, or `.jpg` vs `.png`).	Search the library, copy the exact name into the workbook, preview again. See section 4.6.
A picture inside a table cell is missing	Same name mismatch, or the image was never uploaded.	Upload it and check the name.
A table appears as a block of code text	The JSON is incomplete or damaged (a bracket or quote is missing), or was cut across several cells.	Re-copy the JSON from Table JSON and paste it again into a single cell.
"Please choose an XLSX or XLS spreadsheet file"	You selected another file type.	Save the sheet as `.xlsx` and choose it again.
"Required source headers are missing" in the Formatter	The supplier file lacks a required column.	Add the column (section 6.1) and retry.
"Duplicate specification found"	The same attribute and value appear twice for a product.	Review them. Remove the repeat in the workbook, or click **Continue After Cleanup**.
Generation stops and reports a failure	One product row could not be built (for example broken JSON or unreadable data).	Preview the first product; check the failing row's cells; fix and run again.
Fewer PDFs than products	Two rows share a stock number, so one file overwrote the other. Or a blank row was skipped.	Make every stock number unique.
Nothing downloads after "PDFs ready"	The browser blocked the automatic download.	Click **Download ZIP** or **Download PDF**, or allow downloads for this site.
Preview takes a long time	Large pictures take longer to prepare.	Wait a little. Later previews of the same file are quick.
"No table could be detected"	The selected area is too small, blurry, or lacks the header row.	Select the whole table including its header, or use a sharper picture.
Extracted values are slightly wrong	OCR misread small characters from a picture.	Correct them in the JSON text box. Use a PDF or a higher-resolution picture if possible.
Section name is odd, or blank	The title above the table was cropped away.	Type the correct name in **Section name**.

A bulk entry is marked “need attention”	No structured table could be found in that PDF.	Use **Manual crop** for that file.
Uploaded image name looks different	The library replaces spaces and special characters with underscores.	Copy the stored name shown on the card into the workbook.

8.2 When you need help

Please collect the following before contacting the technical team — it usually shortens the fix to minutes:

- ✓ A screenshot of the whole browser window, including any red message.
- ✓ The name of the workbook and the **row number** of the product that fails.
- ✓ What you clicked just before the problem, in order.

CHAPTER 9

9 Quick reference

9.1 Daily workflow checklist

PREPARE

- ✓ Open Datasheet Studio in Chrome or Edge.
- ✓ Supplier file only? Run it through the **XLSX Formatter**.
- ✓ Open the uniform workbook; check stock numbers are unique.

ADD CONTENT

- ✓ Upload new pictures in the **Image Library**.
- ✓ Copy exact image names into the workbook.
- ✓ Extract tables with **Table JSON** and paste them into `variant_json` columns.

CHECK

- ✓ Save the workbook.
- ✓ Choose the PDF header layout.
- ✓ **Preview PDF**: photo, features and tables look right.

PRODUCE

- ✓ Click **Generate PDFs** and resolve any duplicates.
- ✓ Keep the tab open until it finishes.
- ✓ Open one or two PDFs to confirm the result, then archive the ZIP.

9.2 Glossary

Term	Meaning
Batch	Many products processed together from one workbook or one set of PDFs.
Bulk PDF	Table JSON mode that reads many PDFs automatically.
Crop	The rectangle you draw around a table so only that area is read.
Datasheet	The PDF document describing one product.
Duplicate specification	The same attribute and value listed twice for one product.
Header layout	The choice of part-number lines printed under the product title.
Image Library	The stored collection of pictures, found by file name.
JSON	A text format for structured data. Table JSON describes a table as text.
Label (row 2)	The friendly column name in the second header row.
OCR	Optical character recognition: reading text from a picture.
Role (row 1)	The technical column name in the first header row, such as `variant_json`.
Section	One titled block of a datasheet, usually a table.
SKU / stock number	The product code; it also names the PDF file.
Supplier workbook	A workbook as sent by a supplier, before formatting.

Uniform workbook	The standard workbook layout the PDF generator reads.
`variant_json`	The role name for a column that holds table JSON.
ZIP	One compressed file that holds many PDFs.

9.3 Limits at a glance

Item	Limit
Workbook for the XLSX Formatter	60 MB
Source file for Manual crop	25 MB
Bulk PDF extraction	30 PDF files per batch, 80 MB each
Scanned PDFs in Bulk mode	The first 10 pages of each PDF are read
Image upload	Hundreds of pictures at once
PDF preview	Repeating the same preview (same file and header layout) is instant for about 10 minutes

★ **That is everything**

If a screen ever looks different from this manual, the red numbered circles and the description under each picture will still help you find the matching control. Keep this PDF open beside the website the first few times you work.